

RESEARCH INTERESTS

The design of clinical trials and the development of analytic methods, to extend computational frameworks and tools for both statisticians and medical professionals to work with longitudinal, multicenter data or large-scale, high-dimensional data.

EDUCATION

- 2024-2028 **Boston University**, Boston, MA
Ph.D. Student in Biostatistics: Research on the Framingham Heart Study under the supervision of Prof. Chunyu Liu. [\[R, SAS, and shell scripting; longitudinal analysis; sampling-based models\]](#)
- 2015-2020 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
M.S., Biostatistics, *Not Providing Point-scaled Grades*
B.S., Biostatistics with a second major in Computer Science and a math minor, *Distinction*
Advisor: Prof. Di Wu
Thesis: Weighted inference of gene expression variability in single cell RNAseq data for gene set tests: a replication study. [\[R; high-dimensional scRNA-seq data; permutation-based models\]](#)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2021-2024 **Boston Children's Hospital**, Boston, MA
Biostatistician – Biostatistics and Research Department, supervised by Dr. Edie Weller
- **Simulation study:** Based on structures resembling clinic data from the Extracorporeal Life Support Organization (ELSO) Registry to evaluate model performances regarding different types of data and correlation strengths. [\[R; electronic health records \(EHRs\); LASSO regression\]](#)
 - **Prediction:** Employed [random survival forests](#) on clustered data to identify key features predicting in-hospital mortality following ECPR, and to assess the prediction accuracy of current ELSO registry data. [\[R; EHRs\]](#)
 - **Experimentation and AB tests:** Used [Cox models with mixed effects](#) on [clustered right-censored data](#) for association analysis [2, 3, 4]. Also validated the theoretical framework of optimizing partial likelihood for [time-dependent covariates](#) [6]. Analyzed complex survey data containing six imputations of the missing data to assess the impact of federal welfare programs on children's physical and mental health indicators [1]. Performed chi-squared tests for association analysis of a single center, retrospective study on the onset of epileptic spasms [5].
 - **Tool development:** Developed an [R package](#) with custom functions and a [Shiny app](#) to streamline the data cleaning and descriptive statistics presentation of [extensive, yet unorganized, patient data containing clinical notes from the REDCap database](#). Enabled researchers to efficiently generate metadata via API [7].

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

- Fall 2020 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
Graduate Research Assistant – Biostatistics, supervised by Dr. Donglin Zeng
- Used [R](#) to combine national data of social determinants including social vulnerability index, dates of COVID policies such as shut-downs and facial-masks-in-public, U.S. mobility changes provided by Google Map, and demographics. The aim is to assist a doctoral researcher to use them as covariates in trend prediction models.
- Spring 2019 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
Graduate Teaching Assistant – BIOS 661, supervised by Dr. Fengchang Lin
- Graded homework and answered questions for graduate-level courses in Probabilities and Statistical Inferences.
- 2018-2019 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
Undergraduate Honors Thesis – Biostatistics, advised by Dr. Di Wu
- Conducted a hypothesis test for differential gene expression of single cell RNA sequencing where gene level variability was defined as the test measure.
 - Wrote [R](#) functions to address the mean-variance relationship for zero-inflated RNA-seq counts (32,738 genes and 2,692 cells).

- 2017-2018 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
Undergraduate Research Assistant – Biomedical Research Imaging Center (BRIC), Drs. Dinggang Shen & Dong Nie
- Fine-tuned convolutional neural networks (CNNs) in Python (Keras) to classify brain-glioma grades from 128 MRI scans. Investigated stochastic network variants and tailored the models for real-time inference on embedded medical-imaging systems.
- 2016-2017 **University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**, Chapel Hill, NC
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant – Computer Science, supervised by Prof. Kris Jordan
- Used Java to assist 100+ undergraduate students in understanding core concepts of object-oriented languages, including abstraction and polymorphism. Designed coding exercises, assignment worksheets, and study guides, and held office hours.

AWARDS

- 2019 **Undergraduate Honors Thesis with Distinction, UNC**
- 2018 **Phi Beta Kappa, the Phi Beta Kappa Society**
- 2018 **Carolina Research Scholar Award, UNC**
- 2017 **GHC Student Scholarship, AnitaB.org** (Grace Hopper Celebration of Women in Computing)
- 2013 **Second Prize at National Olympiad in Informatics (NOI), China** (Language Used: C++)

PUBLICATIONS

Accepted or In Review

- 2025 [1] S. Taneja, J. He, L. Marcil, E. Weller, L. K. Lee. "Association of Social Program Participation with Health, Healthcare Access, and Utilization Among Children in Low-Income Families." In Review 2025.

Full Publications

- 2025 [2] Soulsby, W.D., Olveda, R., He, J., Berbert, L., Weller, E., Barbour, K.E., Greenlund, K.J., Schanberg, L.E., von Scheven, E., Hersh, A. and Son, M.B.F., 2025. Racial Disparities and Achievement of the Low Lupus Disease Activity State: A CARRA Registry Study. *Arthritis Care & Research*, 77(1), pp.38-49.
- 2024 [3] Andresen, F., He, J., Weller, E., Goldberg, B., Reilly, C.R., Nakano, T.A., Bertuch, A.A., Geddis, A.E., Joos, M., Coyne, K. and Brundige, K., 2024. Outcomes of Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation for High-Risk Marrow Features without Malignancy in Shwachman-Diamond Syndrome. *Blood*, 144, p.441.
- [4] Myers, K., He, J., Goldberg, B., Reilly, C.R., Wan, Y., Zhu, X., Cesaro, S., Cipolli, M., Bertuch, A.A., O'Farrell, C. and Watanabe, K., 2024. Incidence of Myeloid Malignancy in Shwachman-Diamond Syndrome: An International Cohort Study. *Blood*, 144(Supplement 1), pp.2703-2703.
- [5] Hadjinicolaou, A., Briscoe Abath, C., Singh, A., Donatelli, S., Salussolia, C.L., Cohen, A.L., He, J., Gupta, N., Merchant, S., Zhang, B. and Olson, H., 2024. Timing the clinical onset of epileptic spasms in infantile epileptic spasms syndrome: A tertiary health center's experience. *Epilepsia*.
- 2023 [6] Mamolea, C., He, J., Weller, E., Hoskote, A., Ryan, K., Cooper, D., Bhaskar, P., Thiagarajan, R. and Vitali, S., 2023. 207: Factors and Outcomes Associated with Circuit Change in the Neonatal and Pediatric ECLS populations: An Analysis of the ELSO Registry. *ASAIO Journal*, 69(Supplement 3), p.54.
- 2022 [7] Maddux, A.B., Berbert, L., Young, C.C., Feldstein, L.R., Zambrano, L.D., Kucukak, S., Newhams, M.M., Miller, K., FitzGerald, M.M., He, J. and Halasa, N.B., 2022. Health impairments in children and adolescents after hospitalization for acute COVID-19 or MIS-C. *Pediatrics*, 150(3), p.e2022057798.